

To Jordan Came Our Lord, The Christ

Words: Martin Luther, 1541. Translated by Richard Massie, 1854.

Music: 'Christ, Unser Herr' Johann Walter, 1524.

Setting: composite from "Kern des Deutschen Kirchengesangs", 1855 and "Mehrstimmiges ChoralBuch", 1906.
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♩ = 120

1. To Jor - dan came our Lord the Christ, To do God's plea - sure will - ing, And
 2. So hear ye all, and well per - ceive What God doth call bap - ti - sm, And
 3. To show us this, He hath His Word With signs and sym - bols gi - ven; On
 4. In ten - der man - hood Je - sus straight To ho - ly Jor - dan wend - eth; The
 5. Thus Je - sus His dis - ci - ples sent: Go teach ye e - very na - tion, That

there was by Saint John bap - - tized, All
 what a Christ - - ian should be - - lieve Who
 Jor - - dan's banks was plain - - - ly heard The
 Ho - - ly Ghost from Hea - - - ven's gate In
 lost in sin they must re - - - pent; And

right - eous - - ness ful - - fill - - - ing; There did He
 er - - ror shuns and schi - - - sm: That we should
 Fa - - ther's voice from Hea - - - ven: "This is My
 dove - - like shape de - - scen - - - deth; That thus My
 flee from con - dem - na - - - tion: He that be -

con - - se - - crate a bath To wash a - - way trans -
 wa - - ter use, the Lord De - - clar - - eth it His
 well - be - - lo - - ved Son, In - - - whom My soul de -
 truth be not de - - nied, Nor should our faith e'er
 - lies and is bap - - tized, Ob - - tains a might - - y

- gres - - - sion, And quench the bit - - ter - - ness
 - plea - - - sure; Not sim - - ple wa - - ter, but
 - light - - - eth; Hear Him." Yea, hear Him e - -
 wa - - - ver, That the Three Per - - sons all
 bless - - - ing; A new - - born man, no more

of death By His own blood and pas - - sion; He would a new life give us.
 the Word And Spi - rit with - out mea - - sure; He is the true Bap - ti - - zer.
 - very one Whom He Him - self in - vi - - teth, Hear and o - bey His teach - - ing.
 pre - side, At bap - tism's ho - ly la - - ver, And dwell with the be - lie - - ver.
 he dies, E - ter - nal life pos - ses - - sing, A joy - ful heir of Hea - - ven.

6. Who in this mercy hath not faith, Nor aught therein discerneth,
 Is yet in sin, condemned to death, And fire that ever burneth;
 His holiness avails him not, Nor aught which he is doing;
 His inborn sin brings all to naught, And maketh sure his ruin;
 Himself he cannot succor.

7. The eye of sense alone is dim, And nothing sees but water;
 Faith sees Christ Jesus, and in Him The Lamb ordained for slaughter;
 She sees the cleansing fountain red With the dear blood of Jesus,
 Which from the sins inherited From fallen Adam frees us,
 And from our own misdoings.